and musicians, during the T'ang dynasty (618–906 CE). The last record of the Pyū in Chinese records occurs during the early Song dynasty.

Beikthano flourished from the first to the fourth century CE, while Thayekhettaya flourished from the fourth to eighth centuries CE. Sometime after the fifth century, one of the Pyū tribes, the Burman, began migrating south from present-day Yunnan. The Burman moved south along the Ayeyarwaddy, eventually settling in the fertile plain along the middle course of the Ayeyarwaddy River. Successive invasions slowly weakened the Pyū, thus allowing Burmans to settle in what had previously been Pyū territory. According to Fan Ch'o, author of the *Man-shu*, the kingdom of Nan-Chou in Yunnan attacked and plundered the Pyū capital of Halin around 823–825 CE, enslaving 3,000 Pyū captives and dispersing thousands more into the surrounding areas. Following the invasion by the Nan-Chou the Pyū entered a period of rapid decline in the early ninth century, which the Burman exploited. The Burman filled the post-conflict political vacuum created in the aftermath of Nan-Chou invasions by establishing Bagan as their capital in 849 CE. Pyū language and culture seem to have been slowly absorbed by the advancing Burman. Pyū cities were eventually abandoned by their inhabitants following the fall of Halingyi. The last mention of the Pyū can be found at Bagan in the Rajakumar inscription of 1113 CE. After that the Pyū and Pyū script disappear from history.

ARAKAN

There is no archaeological evidence to support who the earliest inhabitants of Arakan were. Most likely they included some of the ethnic groups that live in the more remote areas of the present-day Rakhine state of the Union of Myanmar: the Chin, the Kami, the Mro, and the Sak. The first evidence of the Arakanese themselves dates from the ninth century CE. This suggests that the Arakanese were originally one of the Pyū tribes that crossed the Arakan Yomo following the destruction of the Pyū polities by the armies of the Nan-Chou. The early polities were located in the valleys and floodplains of the Kaladan and Lemro Rivers.

The Arakanese chronicles date the origins of the Arakan people to 3000 BCE and the legendary founder of Dhanyawadi, Marayu. The chronicles further state that a series of 60 kings from the four cities of Lemro River